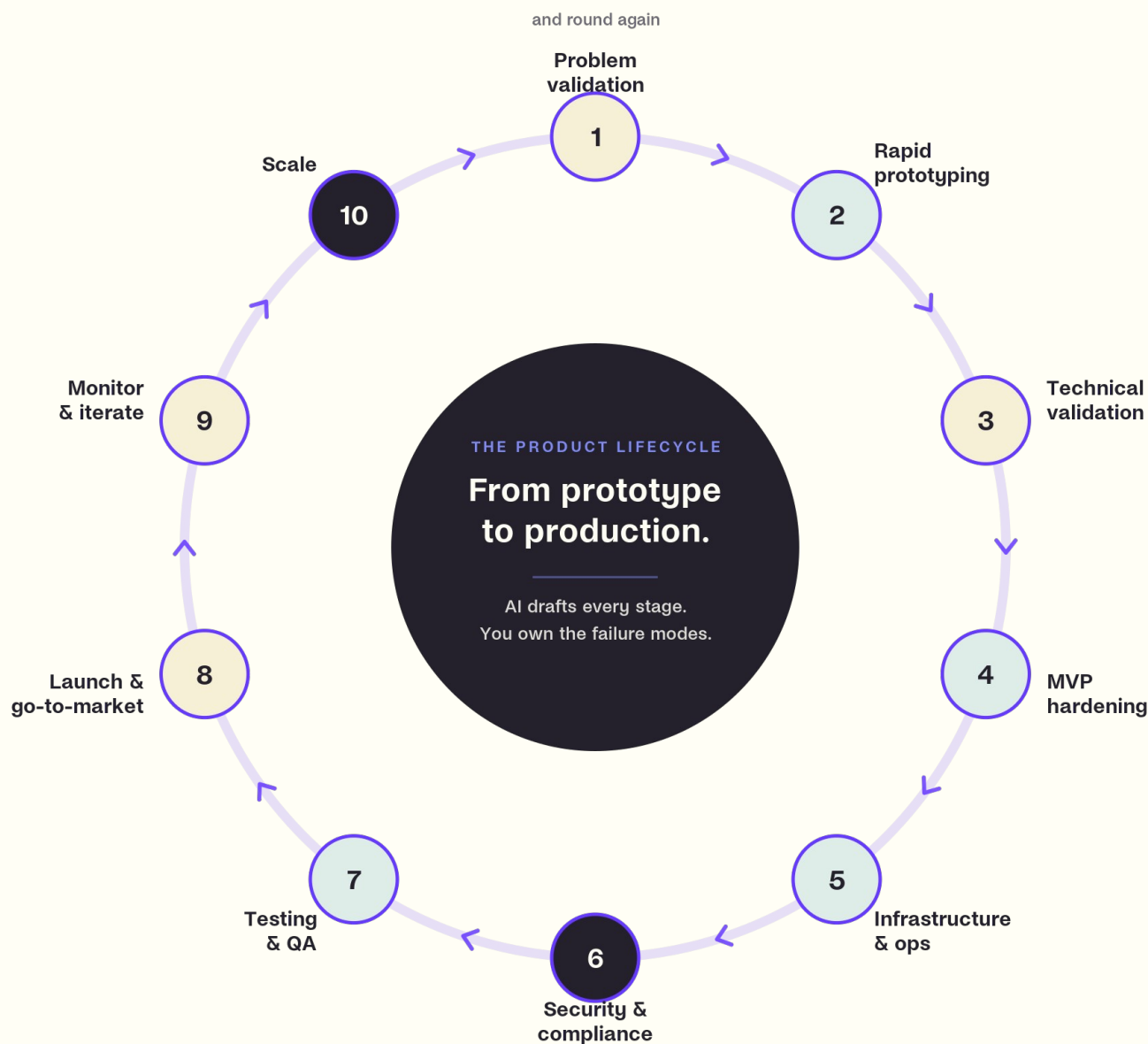


PRODUCT LIFECYCLE, WITH AN AI ACCELERATION LAYER

From prototype to production.

The whole journey as one loop. Colour shows how far AI can take each stage, and where a human still owns the call.



TRUST

Near-final

quick check

Strong draft

real rework

Assist only

stays human

Where to start: the two stages where AI only assists, **Security & compliance** and **Scale**, are where a mistake is most expensive and most human. Bring in real help there first.

Built for apps and software, not physical products (physical goods add sourcing, tooling and logistics this doesn't cover).

Framework by Pulaq Pathak, Head of Product, AI Knowledge Platforms, Amazon Customer Service. Plain-language edition for AI in Action, Turing College × Women in Tech UK.

PRODUCT LIFECYCLE, WITH AN AI ACCELERATION LAYER

From prototype to production.

AI drafts something at every stage. Your job is knowing where a human still catches the failure.

TRUST

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quick check

Strong draft

real rework

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STAGE	WHAT AI CAN DRAFT	WHAT YOU OWN	TRUST
1 Problem validation <i>Is this worth building?</i>	Synthesises interviews, drafts surveys and personas	Talking to real users, and the "will they pay?" call	Strong draft
2 Rapid prototyping <i>Build something you can click</i>	Builds the working app (Lovable, Bolt, v0)	Deciding what to build in the first place	Near-final
3 Technical validation <i>Will it hold up?</i>	Sketches how it's built, flags the risky parts	Signing off the hard-to-undo calls: data structure, vendor lock-in	Strong draft
4 MVP hardening <i>Make it safe for real users</i>	Sets up logins, input checks and error handling	Reviewing it before real user data touches it	Near-final
5 Infrastructure & ops <i>The plumbing that keeps it running</i>	Sets up the pipes that ship, host and monitor it	Ops judgment when it breaks at 2am	Near-final
6 Security & compliance <i>Keep it legal and safe</i>	Scans the code for vulnerabilities	Compliance, and who's liable when it goes wrong	Assist only
7 Testing & QA <i>Catch the bugs</i>	Writes and runs the checks that catch bugs	Deciding what "done" actually means	Near-final
8 Launch & go-to-market <i>Get it into the world</i>	Drafts onboarding copy and messaging	Pricing and positioning strategy	Strong draft
9 Monitor & iterate <i>Learn and improve</i>	Summarises analytics, flags the odd patterns	Deciding what to build next	Strong draft
10 Scale <i>Grow it up</i>	Helps tune cost and performance	Growing the team and the business	Assist only

Where to start: the two stages where AI only assists, **Security & compliance** and **Scale**, are where a mistake is most expensive and most human. Bring in real help there first.